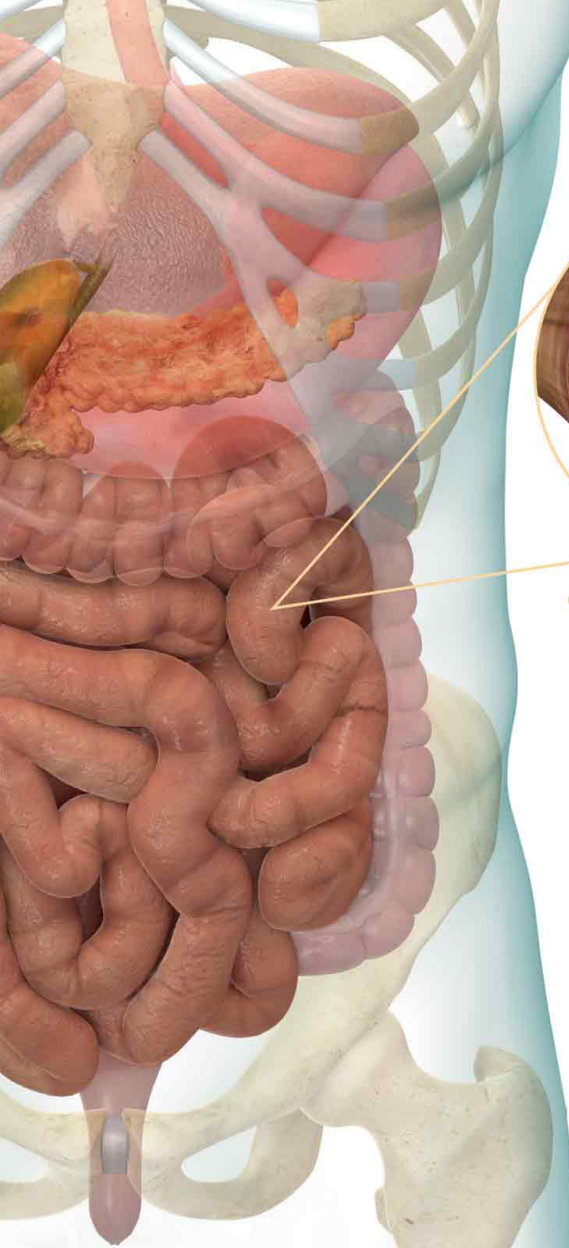
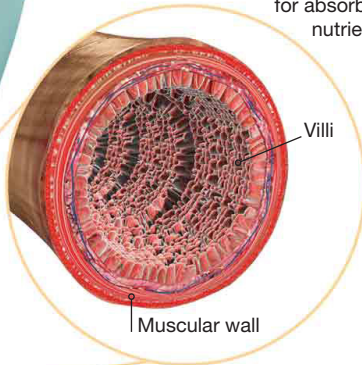




Lining the wall of the small intestine are millions of fingerlike **villi**. These provide a huge surface area for absorbing nutrients.



Peristalsis

Muscles contract and relax in waves to push food along the small intestine and other parts of the digestive tract. This is called peristalsis.

